The City Morgue's Second Annual "Take Your Daughter to Work Day"

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Boss: Okay, attention everyone. Put down your bone saws and quit farting around…eyes up here. That includes you three chatty Cathy's in the back.

Edward: There's only three of us employees altogether.

Snowden: Yeah, and we're standing right in front of you.

(ACTOR'S NOTE: Snowden is an 83 year-old-man).

Boss: Hey! What do I say when it comes to pointing out my flaws?

Snowden: Uh…don't do it?

Boss: Precisely! Thanks Moses.

Snowden: My name is Snowden.

Boss: Whatever, Father Time. Now, as some of you may remember, 364 days ago a government official that was doing a yearly inspection of our morgue accosted me in my office—finding both myself and my friend doing a little bit of our own "bone-sawing" if you know what I mean.

(Boss raises his eyebrows up and down. Leroy, a dim-witted southern-accented man, forces laughter).

Leroy: I, sir, know exactly what you mean…

(Leroy high fives Boss. Leroy then leans over and whispers to Dave).

Leroy: What exactly does he mean?

Boss: Okay, that's enough of your little side conversations guys. Anyway, turns out she might have lied about her age to me. I can recall assuming she was 25, but that ended up being about (thinks momentarily) eight years off. Now I'm not saying whether she was actually 17 or (adds again momentarily in his head) 32…er, 33. We'll just say that the official believed me to be doing somewhat immoral, even though I wasn't doing anything illegal at all. Right, Leroy? This guy knows what I'm talking about!

(Boss high fives Leroy again. Leroy smiles)

Leroy: Yeah, I do!

(He then whispers to Dave again)

Leroy: I have no idea what that guy's talking about…

Edward: I thought you said you weren't doing anything with that girl. That's what you told me, at least—you said she was just here on a high school internship program.

Boss: Okay, yes, that's true. But the agent was kind of cute, so I didn't want her to think I was a square or something. Anyway, to make a short story shorter, after convincing the lady I was canoodling with the student in my office, I realized the consequences and then made an attempt to convince the government

worker it was Take-Your-Daughter-To-Work Day and that that was why the high school junior was in my office. Now, she said she'd believe me if we had any documented history of past Take-Your-Daughter-To-Work Days. Since we don't, I had to tell her that it was our first one. She said she'd come back a year from that date—tomorrow—to check to see if we were having a second one or she'd call the police and I said "fine, do it" and she said "fine, I will," and I said "fine, why don't you bring the police with you?" and she said "fine, I will do that too! Thanks for the idea," and I said "no problem what are friends for if not quality ideas?" and she said "my friends are for convincing me it's okay to get dessert," and I'm like "giggle, titter! Not mine! No convincing needed—I love dessert," and she said "You and I should get dessert some time!" and I said "Okay, but I have to warn you, I like my dessert like I like my women," and she says "what's that? Luscious and dark?" She was black so this sounded more flirtatious coming from her. Anyway, I said back to her "No! Young and gullible!" and she says "you're a pig! I'll see you in one year with the police!" and I say, "wait! What about dessert?" but she had left my office by this point so I was just standing yelling at nothing…

(Boss forgets what his entire point was. Leroy stands completely confused and bewildered).

Boss: Um…so I think what I'm trying to say is that friendships are more than just convincing each other to get dessert. The unity in this morgue needs to increase if we want to be successful; otherwise we're just going to end up like the bodies we're hacking up—

Edward: I think you were talking about Take-Your-Daughter-To-Work Day.

Boss: Don't interrupt me, Ed! But yes. Tomorrow is going to be our building's Second-Annual-Take-Your-Daughter-To-Work Day. Any questions?

(Leroy raises his hand. Boss calls on him).

Boss: Yes, you! The stupid one.

Leroy: What if we don't have a daughter?

Boss: I don't know…bring your son then.

Leroy: But I don't have a—

Boss: Any other questions?

Edward: Yeah, what are the plusses in convincing a government official you were fooling around with an under-aged girl and that this girl was not some random under-aged girl but instead your daughter?

(Pause)

Boss: No more questions? Okay, so it's official. Tomorrow bring your daughter to work for a day of fun and excitement.

Narrator: The Next Day…

(Boss seems stressed out. He's rubbing his forehead out of exhaustion).

Boss: Okay, guys. Now, I know it was short notice on the whole bringing your daughter thing…but what the hell is this? Leroy where is your kid.

(Leroy is holding an object and petting its head).

Leroy: I tried to tell you yesterday, but I don't have any kids.

Boss: Doesn't surprise me. I don't know who would be willing to have intercourse with the Pillsbury doughboy.

Leroy: You'd be surprised what money can buy.

(Boss shudders)

Boss: So explain your reasoning in bringing in…that…thing.

Leroy: This is Chomper…he's my pet alligator.

Boss: You brought an alligator to Take-Your-Daughter-To-Work Day?

Leroy: Yup.

(Silence)

Boss: Okay. How about you Edward? Where's your daughter?

Edward: School.

Boss: And why would you send your daughter to school as opposed to brining her to the morgue?

(Edward sarcastically thinks for a moment stroking his chin, straining his brain.)

Edward: Gee…I…I don't know. I have no argument for why I did that. Deciding not to bring my only child to a place full of corpses as opposed to having her further her education…God, what was I thinking?

(Boss misses sarcasm)

Boss: I'm not sure. But think a little harder about what you're thinking next time! How about you, Snowden? Who's this woman you've brought with you? Your personal nurse?

(Snowden is standing next to a 45-year-old businesswoman. The woman is talking sternly into a cell phone.)

Snowden: Well, this is my daughter, Lucy.

Boss: Daughter…she's like forty-six.

(Lucy hears her name and knows it's time for her to say hello. She tries to pause her phone conversation).

Lucy: …I don't care about how many houses he sold last year; he shouldn't be shooting up heroine in the women's locker room! Excuse me for a moment…

(Lucy looks up and suddenly starts feigning a smile. She reaches her hand out to shake that of Boss.)

Lucy: Lucy Swift. Pleasure to meet you.

Boss: Pleasure to meet me? Well, guess what young lady? That makes you the second woman I've pleasured today.

(Boss high fives Lucy's extended hand. She pulls her arm back slowly and disgustedly. Then she gets back on the phone.)

Lucy: Hello, are you still there? Okay, good. Now, if he's unresponsive, I need you to put his pants back on, call an ambulance and get the ostrich out our office building.

Boss: Well, this is my daughter, everyone. I want you all to say hi to Kay-sha.

(Keisha is an angry little 8-year-old with a loud voice and a temper.)

Keisha: My name is Key-sha, not Kay-sha!

Boss: Oh! They're just little fireballs at this age, aren't they?

Leroy: (depressed) I wouldn't know…

(Boss laughs awkwardly at his "fireballs" comment and rubs Keisha's shoulder. She bites his hand).

Boss: Awe! Sonofa….Jesus…

(Boss holds his hand in pain).

Leroy: Hey, Boss. Maybe I'm wrong—

Boss: Wouldn't surprise me…

Leroy: —but I thought you didn't have any kids.

Edward: Yeah. In fact, didn't the government specifically say you legally wouldn't be allowed to procreate?

Boss: The government says a lot of things…not many of which I listen to…(giving up) Okay, you caught me. This isn't my daughter. I'm sure you can tell from our differing tempers.

Edward: That and she's a different race than you are.

Boss: Oh, aren't we Mr. Funny.

Edward: I wasn't joking.

Snowden: Sir, I'm a little worried of how you acquired a young girl.

Boss: I found this young girl at the park today.

Edward: Found her at the park? You mean you kidnapped that little girl!

Boss: Now Edward, kidnapped is such a nasty word…

(Silence while everyone waits for Boss to finish his sentence).

Snowden: And…

Boss: And what?

Edward: When you say something is a "nasty word," you are supposed to follow it up by saying you prefer something else better, implying you are doing the positive connotationed word as opposed to the negative one.

Boss: Oh, I'm not denying that I kidnapped her. In fact, I kidnapped the living bejesus out of this little girl. But that doesn't make the word kidnap sound nice, now does it. Anyway, I'm very disappointed in you guys. I can't believe I'm the only one who brought a legitimate daughter to work!

Snowden: Actually, I think I'm the only one who brought in a legitimate daughter, seeing as how you kidnapped yours and his is an alligator.

Boss: Yeah, but yours doesn't count. She's old!

Snowden: She's younger than you.

Boss: Yeah, and I probably couldn't pass as your daughter either, now could I? Maybe think before you speak next time, Grandpa!

Leroy: Well, I love Chomper like I would a child. And I think that's what really makes something a "legitimate" son or daughter…love.

Boss: That's great, Leroy, however you're love is defecating all over your shirt.

Leroy: Sometimes you just got to go with it—you know…

(Pause)

Boss: No I don't think I do actually "know." Listen everyone. Although you guys all have pathetic excuses for daughters, except possibly your daughter Snowden—she herself looks the right age to have a somewhat cute child still—anyway, we have to make this work. Everyone needs to take their places doing what they normally do. Just show your daughter how your job works so when the government official comes back, we'll look somewhat normal.

Edward: (Sarcastically) Act normal, despite the fact Keisha's parents probably think she's dead right now?

(Boss is shocked by this comment. He covers Keisha's ears).

Boss: God, what is wrong with you? Don't say things like that in front of her, especially if they are probably true!

Keisha: I can hear everything you're saying.

(Boss lets go of her ears)

Boss: Thank goodness you didn't bring your daughter to work today, Ed. You seem mentally unhealthy. And that kind of thing can rub off on a child so easily; you'd scar them for life! Now, everyone disperse and show your kids how to embalm bodies and check for causes of deaths and what not.

Narrator: Later that afternoon…

Snowden: You see, honey, after we check the pulse we can declare them legally dead and send them on their way to the next step, which is diagnosing the cause of death.

(Lucy is not listening to her father at all but is still jabbering on into her phone about business and work.)

Lucy: …so you're telling me you didn't close the deal because you fell asleep watching Wife Swap? I don't know how much longer our company can deal with your behavior. First the meatloaf incident and now this!

(Boss suddenly comes running in to talk to everyone).

Boss: ATTENTION EVERYONE! She is here! She is outside coming in right now WITH a police officer. Places everyone. I'm not going back to prison again! Wait, has anyone seen Kay-sha?

Edward: It's Key-sha.

Boss: Whatever that little Satan's name is—where is she? Probably, birthing the anti-christ or something preposterous like that.

(Chomper begins squirming in Leroy's arms.)

Leroy: Whoa! Chomper! What are you doing!

(Chomper jumps out of Leroy's arms onto the ground and crawls quickly into the middle of the group. All eyes—excluding Lucy's, who is still on the phone—are on him. There is a moment of silence before Chomper burps up a small child's shoe. Silence again.)

Snowden: Did that alligator just burp up a kid's shoe?

Leroy: I thought he felt heavier.

Boss: Are you saying your crocodile just ate my fake daughter?

(Leroy laughs.)

Leroy: That's a dumb question. It obviously is an alligator, not a crocodile. You can tell from his broad snout.

(Boss stares at Leroy for a moment, showing absolutely not emotion. Than, he snaps and attacks Leroy, overcome with rage. Leroy tries to push Boss back.)

Leroy: Whoa! Sir, you don't want to act hostile towards me. Otherwise Chomper is going to think his master is getting threatened and he's going to—

(Boss punches Leroy. Chomper jumps up and grabs onto Boss's stomach. Boss lets go of Leroy and falls back, Chomper hanging from his stomach.)

Leroy: —bite you.

Boss: AH! Get it off! Get if off!

Snowden: Get it off him! Get it off him!

Lucy: (on phone)…I just am worried that loosening our gun policy will lower our stock like it did last time. Here, just a sec…(to group) could you guys keep it down? Some of us are trying to get some work done…(to phone)…so yeah. I don't think we should try and change anything this late in the season.

(Boss is biting his lip, trying not to scream or cry. Leroy grabs Chomper and pulls him off. Along with Chomper comes Boss's shirt, still stuck in Chomper's jaws. As Chomper still bites and claws, attempting to bite a now-shirtless Boss again, Boss decides to run into his office, picking up Keisha's shoe as defense).

Leroy: I'm sorry boss! I really am! He should let go of your shirt here as soon as he calms down and you can put it back on.

Boss: Stay back, gator! I'll shoe you!

(Boss suddenly realizes how ridiculous he looks and tries to cool his composure.)

Boss: I'll be in my office if anybody needs me.

(Boss closes the office door behind him. He sighs with relief since he is out of harm's way. When he looks up, he sees Keisha sitting drawing a picture at his desk.)

Boss: Kay-sha?

Keisha: It's Key-sha! Why do you have my shoe?

(Outside, everyone is somewhat under control now that the alligator situation has ended. Enter the government official with a police officer, as promised.)

Government Official: Hello, everyone. I'm here for what I presume to be, or at least was told would be, Take-Your-Daughter-To-Work Day, here with Officer Stevenson.

Officer Stevenson: Is that a crocodile?

Leroy: A gator actually.

Officer Stevenson: Oh, yeah. I didn't see the broad snout at first.

Government Official: So where is the man in charge of this whole place?

(Everyone points at the office door.)

Officer Stevenson: So is this the guy you thought was doing promiscuous things with minors?

Government Official: If it's the same man from last year, than yes. Maybe we just caught him in a sticky situation last time though. You know? I believe in second chances for everyone.

(Government Official reaches and opens the door to Boss's office. Boss is standing shirtless with an 8-year-old, holding her shoe. Silence as Boss stares at the officer and Government Official.)

Boss: Hey there! This probably looks kind of bad…me shirtless in an office with an 8-year-old girl holding an article of her clothing.

Officer Stevenson: An 8-year-old girl who was reported as being kidnapped from the park today.

(Pause)

Boss: Kidnapped is such a nasty word…

Narrator: The next week…

Snowden: For those of you who don't know, when the police found our old boss shirtless with a kidnapped 8-year-old in his office, he was arrested. And since I was appointed the new manager, all of his old duties will be passed on to me—all of them except the whole sex-with-kids thing. That's not really my kind of scene. I mean there are a time and a place for everything but…sorry. I digress. Anyway, the first order of business is to get Mr. Johnson out of the ceiling tiles. I'm not sure how he got up there, but his family is coming in with his suit this afternoon—

(Enter Boss. Silence as he walks in.)

Boss: Thank you for taking my place momentarily, Snowden. That will be all I need of you.

(Snowden walks over to stand with the rest of the group).

Boss: Okay, everyone. What are all you guys doing just standing around for. Let's freeze some dead people! Boo-ya!

Edward: Sir…I think I speak for the group when I say why the hell are you here?

Boss: Please, Ed. You sound like my mother. For those of you who may not have noticed, I was arrested for child molestation recently. Now, you all know that this is no laughing matter, but I think we can look back and say that it was pretty funny.

Leroy: How'd you get out of jail?

Boss: God, if I had a nickel for every time I heard that question. I could probably buy something out of the vending machine then! Well, actually does 45 cents buy you something out of the vending machine? Sorry, I'm rambling. Anyway, to get out I had to tell a little white lie, Leroy…the police believe that it was indeed Take-Your-Daughter-To-Work Day. However, I had to tell them that this year, the day fell on a Friday. So not only was it Take-Your-Daughter-To-Work Day, but also was Casual Friday here at the morgue, so that's why I didn't have a shirt on. And then they said "But it's Thursday," and I said "well, every Thursday we have shirtless Thursdays," and they said "well why were you the only shirtless one" and I said "it was our first one, so the fad hasn't really caught on" and they said "well, good luck in inspiring your employees to join in" and I was like "I know! They are all a bunch of negative Nancy's when it comes to getting naked!" Anyway, as for the whole kidnapping thing, there's good news about that too. Kay-sha's parents have been dead for years, so there was no one to sue. So I got that going for me…Any questions?

Edward: Yeah, why didn't you just tell them what really happened? With the alligator?

(Silence)

Boss: No one have a question? Good. You can now get back to work. Oh, yes. The officer and the official are going to start coming in on Thursdays too, to make sure we are all shirtless. So I'm going to have to quit wearing my shirt on Thursdays…and so are you all.

Edward: You're kidding me.

(Leroy starts counting on his fingers).

Boss: What are you doing, Leroy?

Leroy: I'm trying to figure out how many more years I have to work here before I see another Shirtless Thursday and Take-Your-Daughter-To-Work Day fall on the same afternoon. (Finishes counting). Darn! Seven years! Doubt I'll ever get to see Lucy shirtless…

Boss: Why? Are you planning on quitting before than?

Leroy: No, I'm just guessing Snowden will have died before that.

Snowden: That offends me…the fact that you want to see my daughter shirtless, not the me dieing thing. I'm not even betting I'll make it to the sixth annual Take-Your-Daughter-To-Work Day.

Edward: So, not only are we maintaining the yearly Take-Your-Daughter-To-Work Day, but also we are starting a Shirtless Thursday?

Boss: Yes, Edward. And if you ask why, it's because here at the City Morgue, we are a family. We look out for each other. We love each other. We feed off each other. We help each other out when one of us is accused of being a sex offender. And that's something no one can take away from us: no one except for policemen that aren't so easily persuaded by my fake stories. Now don't let these incidents get you down. I still want us to be on our best game when working today, tomorrow, and even the day after that. The day after that we can let our guards down though, since that's a Sunday, and government workers have that day off. But come Monday, the fooling around is done again. Now let's go out there and be the best damn morticians we can be! Any questions?

Edward: Chomper isn't going to come in on Shirtless Thursdays, is he?

(Boss winces thinking about the possibility and reaches up to feel his nipples).

Boss: God, I hope not…